

Cumulus Bank

Commercial banking from Cumulus Bank



TREASURY MANAGEMENT

TM-POS-PAY-2026.04 · Effective April 25, 2026

PRODUCT BROCHURE · TREASURY MANAGEMENT

Positive Pay

Check and ACH fraud-prevention service with payee-match, daily exception review, and pay-or-return defaults — integrated with Business Online for straightforward exception resolution.

SERVICES	Check Positive Pay · Payee Match · ACH Positive Pay
EXCEPTION DEADLINE	11:00 a.m. ET daily
DEFAULT ACTION	Pay or return — client-configurable
PRICING	\$35 / month + \$0.05 / item
ISSUANCE FILE FORMATS	CSV · XML · ISO 20022 pain.002 · manual entry
DECISION CHANNEL	Business Online dashboard + mobile
REVERSE POSITIVE PAY	Available as alternative structure
ACH FILTER OPTIONS	Block · allow-list · amount caps · SEC codes



AT A GLANCE

Overview

Cumulus Positive Pay compares each check and ACH debit presented for payment against an authorized issuance file (for checks) or an authorized-originator list (for ACH). Items that match — by check number, amount, and optionally payee name — pay without intervention. Items that do not match are 'exceptions' and are presented to the client each business day for a pay or return decision. Positive Pay is the most effective single control against counterfeit check fraud, check alteration, and unauthorized ACH debits; Cumulus recommends it for every business that issues checks or receives ACH debits.

WHY POSITIVE PAY

Key benefits

COUNTERFEIT AND ALTERATION PROTECTION Counterfeit and alteration protection Check Positive Pay identifies items that do not match issued check number or amount — stopping counterfeits and alterations before they post.	PAYEE MATCH FOR ENHANCED CONTROL Payee Match for enhanced control OCR-based payee comparison flags items where the payee name on the check does not match the issued payee — catching forged or altered-payee fraud.
ACH FILTER AND BLOCK ACH filter and block ACH Positive Pay blocks all ACH debits by default; pre-authorized originators with SEC-code, amount, and frequency controls are permitted.	EXCEPTION REVIEW IN BUSINESS ONLINE Exception review in Business Online Daily exception dashboard with check images, prior-issued comparison, and one-click pay / return decisions.
INSURANCE POLICY ALIGNMENT Insurance policy alignment Many commercial crime / cyber insurance policies require Positive Pay as a condition of coverage for check and ACH fraud; Cumulus provides AOC-equivalent documentation.	MOBILE EXCEPTION REVIEW Mobile exception review Exception decisions available via the Cumulus Business Mobile app; push notifications at exception-file post so no exception is missed.

DAILY CYCLE

How Check Positive Pay works



STEP	ACTIVITY	TIMING / CUT-OFF (ET)
1 · Issuance file	Client submits issuance file to Cumulus whenever checks are issued — via CSV, XML, ISO 20022 pain.002, Business Online upload, or direct ERP integration.	Any time prior to check presentment
2 · Presentment	Checks present for payment through paper clearing, Day-1 ACH image exchange, or check-image deposit.	Continuous
3 · Match	Cumulus matches each presented check against the issuance file on check number, amount, and (if enabled) payee name.	Real-time
4 · Exception file	Non-matching items post to the Business Online exception dashboard by 7:00 a.m. ET each business day.	7:00 a.m.
5 · Decision	Client reviews exceptions with check images; decides pay or return on each.	Before 11:00 a.m.
6 · Default	Items without a decision at 11:00 a.m. default to the client's pre-selected action (pay or return).	11:00 a.m.
7 · Post	Paid items post to the account; returned items dispute-coded as 'Refer to Maker' and return to the depositing bank.	Same day

SERVICE FEES

Pricing

SERVICE	AMOUNT
Check Positive Pay — monthly account fee	\$35 / account / month
Check Positive Pay — per-item fee	\$0.05 per presented check
Payee Match — monthly account fee	\$15 / account / month (add-on to Check Positive Pay)
ACH Positive Pay — monthly account fee	\$25 / account / month
ACH Positive Pay — per-item fee	\$0.05 per presented ACH debit
Reverse Positive Pay (alternative)	\$25 / account / month + \$0.05 / item
Issuance-file fee	No charge for standard channels
Exception return	\$0.00 (included)
Manual issuance (per-check data entry in Business Online)	\$0.25 per entry

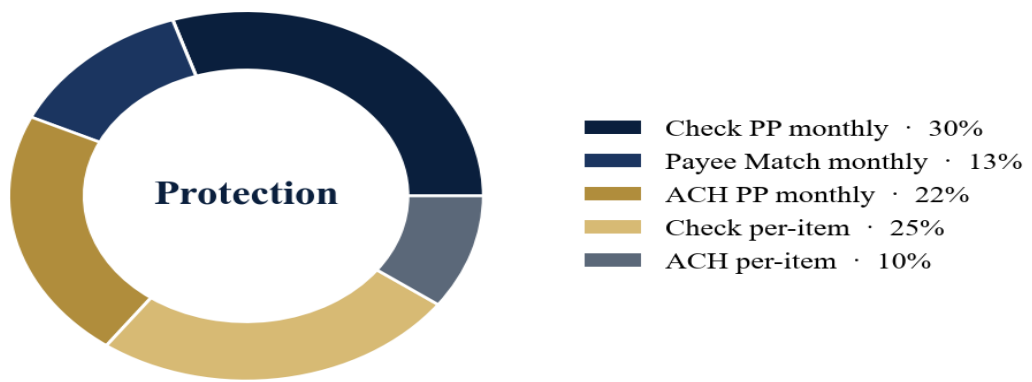
WHERE YOUR FEE GOES

Service fee breakdown

The chart below illustrates a representative monthly Positive Pay cost allocation for a client with two operating accounts, Payee Match, ACH Positive Pay, and 1,000 total items presented per month. Platform fees dominate fixed cost; per-item

fees scale with activity.

Typical monthly Positive Pay cost composition (2 accounts)



BLOCK + AUTHORIZE

ACH Positive Pay

ACH Positive Pay defaults to blocking all ACH debits on the account unless the originator is explicitly authorized. Authorization can be by Originator ID (full trust), Originator + SEC Code, Originator + Amount Cap, Originator + Frequency (e.g., monthly only). Blocked or non-matching items post to the exception dashboard for same-day pay-or-return decision — subject to the same 11:00 a.m. deadline as Check Positive Pay.

AUTHORIZED ORIGINATOR FIELD	CONFIGURATION
Originator ID	The 10-digit company identification number from the ACH addenda (immediately identifies the originator).
Originator name (descriptive)	The originator's descriptive name from the ACH file header — useful for human review but not used for matching.
SEC code restriction	Permit only specific SEC codes (e.g., CCD only, not WEB).
Amount cap	Maximum per-transaction amount for this originator.
Frequency limit	Maximum number of debits per day / week / month.
Effective date range	Authorization valid for a specified date range (e.g., expiring at contract end).

ERP AND AP SYSTEMS

Integration options

— **Direct ERP integration** — issuance file produced automatically from SAP, Oracle, NetSuite, Sage Intacct, Workday, and Microsoft Dynamics — delivered via SFTP, REST API, or direct-transmission channel.



- **AP-system integration** — Coupa, Ariba, Bill.com, and other AP platforms produce Positive Pay issuance files as part of the payment-run workflow.
- **Business Online upload** — CSV, XML, or ISO 20022 pain.002 file uploaded by Treasury operator with automated schema validation.
- **Manual entry** — for low-volume clients issuing fewer than 10 checks per day; includes in-Business-Online check-issuance workflow.
- **ISO 20022 native** — pain.002 issuance file with structured payee, amount, and remittance-reference data.

COMMON QUESTIONS

Frequently asked questions

What's the difference between Positive Pay and Reverse Positive Pay?

Positive Pay compares every presented check to an issuance file and flags non-matching items. Reverse Positive Pay presents all paid checks back to the client for next-day review (without the client supplying an issuance file). Positive Pay is the stronger control; Reverse is a fallback for clients that cannot reliably produce issuance files.

How does Payee Match work?

OCR software reads the payee name from the check image and compares it to the payee on the issuance file. Fuzzy-match logic tolerates minor OCR errors (whitespace, punctuation, stylized printing). Matches above the configured threshold pay automatically; below-threshold items appear as exceptions.

What if I miss the 11:00 a.m. deadline?

Items without a decision by 11:00 a.m. ET default to your pre-selected action (pay or return) recorded on the service schedule. Most clients select 'return' as the default — consistent with a security-first policy — and override to 'pay' on known-good items. Emergency extension requests may be accommodated by contacting the Cumulus Treasury Services desk.

Can I use Positive Pay on accounts at other banks?

No. Positive Pay is a Cumulus service on Cumulus-issued checks and Cumulus-held accounts. Moving your primary operating accounts to Cumulus is the first step to enabling Positive Pay protection.

Do I need Positive Pay if I use electronic payments?

ACH Positive Pay is still essential if you receive ACH debits (e.g., for recurring supplier drafts, utility auto-pay, or insurance premiums). Business-email-compromise attacks increasingly create unauthorized ACH debit attempts, not just check fraud. Most insurers now require both Check and ACH Positive Pay for full fraud coverage.

What's the UCC implication of using Positive Pay?

Under UCC § 4-406, a bank's exercise of ordinary care combined with the customer's use of Positive Pay generally shifts responsibility for unauthorized items: if you use Positive Pay, properly review exceptions, and items posts that you did not authorize, the bank typically bears the loss. If you decline Positive Pay, courts have held the customer bears greater responsibility.



DISCLOSURES & REGULATORY NOTICES

Important disclosures

- § Positive Pay services are provided by Cumulus Bank, N.A. under the Treasury Services Master Agreement and applicable service schedule. Positive Pay mitigates but does not eliminate check and ACH fraud risk. Liability for unauthorized or altered items is governed by UCC Articles 3 and 4, the Cumulus Business Deposit Agreement, and applicable service terms.
- § Issuance-file submission and exception review deadlines are mandatory. Items unresolved by the 11:00 a.m. ET exception deadline default to the client's pre-selected default action (pay or return) under the service schedule.
- § Payee Match depends on OCR accuracy; fuzzy-match thresholds are configurable at setup and reviewed regularly. OCR limitations are inherent — high-contrast, typewritten payee names produce the best match rates; handwritten or cursive payees are not reliably matched.
- § ACH Positive Pay requires a complete authorized-originator list with SEC codes, amount caps, and frequency limits. Changes to the list must be submitted through Business Online or the Cumulus Treasury Administration team.

ENGAGE A SPECIALIST

Connect with a Cumulus commercial banker

A Commercial Relationship Manager will assess your business's banking, credit, and treasury needs, coordinate supporting specialists, and return a term sheet or proposal on an expedited timeline. Existing Cumulus clients should contact their dedicated Relationship Manager directly.

COMMERCIAL DESK

954.417.2880

Client Services, Mon–Fri 7:00 a.m. – 9:00 p.m. ET · Sat 8:00 a.m. – 5:00 p.m. ET

CLIENT PORTAL

cumulusbank-demo-bb054209d76d.herokuapp.com

Apply online, review rates, or schedule an appointment.

TREASURY SERVICES

Commercial banking centers are staffed by appointment. Request a consultation at cumulusbank-demo-bb054209d76d.herokuapp.com/commercial.

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